

Space Economy: Consolidating a Management Research Agenda**Primary sponsor:** Technology and Innovation Management (TIM) Division**Potential co-sponsors:** STR, ENT, PNP, RM, IM, ONE, OMT, OB, MC, OSCM, CTO, HR, MED, DEI, SAP, CM, CMS, SIM, NEUB, CAR, & ODC**ABSTRACT**

The Space Economy (SE) is entering a critical phase of growth and strategic influence, with 80+ countries operating space agencies and owning satellites. The global SE exceeds \$600B and has attracted more than \$270B in private equity and venture capital over the past decade, underscoring its economic and geopolitical significance. Space technologies increasingly shape everyday life—from satellite communications and Earth observation for climate monitoring to positioning, navigation, and timing services—reshaping industries and opening new frontiers for research and innovation. Yet, despite its scale and strategic importance, management research on the SE remains fragmented, leaving core questions on innovation, entrepreneurship, governance, and organizing insufficiently integrated into theory. Building on the record-setting 2025 PDW, the **2026 PDW shifts from introduction of the context to consolidation by co-creating a cumulative research agenda and actionable, collaboration- and publication-oriented research designs.** The workshop focuses on four domains: (1) theoretical developments and integration, (2) innovative methodologies and datasets, (3) emerging phenomena, and (4) policy and practical challenges. The session opens with a distinguished industry keynote, followed by practitioner and academic panels featuring leaders from pioneering space companies such as Axiom Space. Interactive roundtables then pair academic facilitators with participants to develop research designs around predefined themes. Participants will pre-register with a summary of research interests; attendance will be capped at 500. The PDW aims to spark new research ideas, build collaborations, and position management scholars at the forefront of the SE, while strengthening cross-divisional ties and accelerating cumulative, theory-building work in this frontier domain.

RELEVANCE TO THE TIM DIVISION

The SE is pertinent to the TIM division, highlighting a growing sector shaped by technological breakthroughs and evolving business models (BMs). Propelled by venture capital, R&D cycles in the SE have accelerated, generating continuous experimentation that challenges established theories of innovation management (Profitiliotis & Loizidou, 2019). This environment compels us to explore how technologies transition from prototypes to commercial applications under uncertain conditions, while “technology transfers” increasingly loop between space-based and terrestrial markets, reflecting Gonzalez’s (2023) technology transfer and sector fluidity. The SE context emphasizes the critical role of BM innovation as it moves beyond embryonic stages toward growth and commercialization. Firms seeking value creation in orbital manufacturing, in-space services, or satellite-enabled data analytics must adapt or create new BMs tailored to extreme or unpredictable conditions. These conditions place distinctive pressures on BM design, experimentation, and scaling, offering a setting in which TIM scholars can examine how firms balance exploration and exploitation under capital-intensive and technologically interdependent constraints. By foregrounding early-stage BM adaptation, the SE offers a lens through which TIM scholars can examine underexplored periods of industry evolution (McGrath, 2010; Suarez et al., 2015; Gustafsson et al., 2016; Vittori et al., 2022). SE has shifted from public-sector dominance to an ecosystem increasingly enriched by private actors, emphasizing public–private collaborations with NASA and private partners (Heitor et al., 2024; Roy, 2025). Innovation in this context increasingly depends on ecosystem-level coordination, including platform architectures, interface standards, and interdependent components across organizational boundaries. These alliances cultivate ecosystems that introduce new governance complexities around planetary protection and standards-setting. The PDW will demonstrate how organizations navigate technological uncertainty, alliance formation, ecosystem governance, and sustainability challenges in the SE. It has also gained relevance to other divisions, emerging organically through discussions among organizers from multiple divisions (Appendix I).

FORMAT OF THE PDW

This PDW engages management scholars with the SE, highlights key research areas through interactive roundtable discussions. To prioritize interaction, the session will include a brief introduction, a keynote address, an industry panel, an academic panel, and structured roundtable engagement. Each roundtable will be led by 2–4 facilitators, exploring how the SE can be studied through various management disciplines or areas of expertise. Table 1 provides details on roundtables, facilitators, and predefined discussion points. Table 2 provides a more detailed summary of each part.

(0:00–0:10) Welcome and Overview → **(0:10–0:55)** Keynote Address → **(0:55–1:40)** Industry Panel
→ **(1:40–2:25)** Academic Panel → **(2:25–3:30)** Roundtable Pitches and Transition to Roundtables

ROOM REQUIREMENTS

With interest from >70 contributors (Table 3 & Appendix II) and expected attendance of up to 500 plenary participants (pre-registered), the PDW will require a room that supports plenary sessions and facilitated transitions into roundtables. The PDW will feature ~12 roundtables, each accommodating ~14 roundtable participants, including facilitators and assigned note-takers. A room capacity of 500 is recommended. A ballroom-style room is preferred, allowing for flexible reconfiguration between plenary and roundtable layouts. Plenary registration will be capped at 500 (with a waitlist). Roundtable seats will be capped separately and allocated from among registered participants. The room should be equipped with a projection/display system for slides and sufficient microphones to support plenary sessions, panel discussions, audience questions, and brief plenary pitches by roundtable facilitators prior to the transition into table discussions.

Insert tables 1, 2, & 3 about here

OVERVIEW OF THE PDW

Background and Rationale: The Space Economy (SE) as a Multidivisional Research Opportunity

The SE is undergoing rapid growth, driven by accelerated R&D cycles, innovative BMs, and increasing private-sector involvement (Profitiliotis & Loizidou, 2019; Heitor et al., 2024; Roy, 2025). This capital-intensive, high-risk context aligns closely with the TIM division's focus on technological innovation, industry dynamics, and commercialization. As a frontier context, the SE features long development horizons, irreversible downside risk, and deep interdependence between public agencies, primes, and entrepreneurial ventures—conditions that can expose mechanisms and boundary assumptions less visible in terrestrial settings. The SE offers a distinctive empirical setting for investigating technology transfers between space-based and terrestrial markets (Gonzalez, 2023) and the progression of early-stage innovations into commercial applications (McGrath, 2010; Suarez et al., 2015). These processes challenge innovation theory and open opportunities to study BM innovation under extreme uncertainty. Public–private collaborations, such as NASA's partnerships with private firms, have reshaped governance frameworks while offering a natural laboratory for studying the co-evolution of governance and innovation (Heitor et al., 2024). The 2025 PDW attracted an unusually large and diverse group of scholars across divisions, signaling a sustained research community rather than isolated, division-specific interest. Beyond TIM, the SE presents a rich research context for multiple AOM divisions; the divisions referenced below reflect only a subset of the perspectives engaged by the SE. STR scholars contribute perspectives on resilience and strategic adaptation, with the 2014 Virgin Galactic test flight crash illustrating the importance of resilience in decision-making. ENT scholars examine entrepreneurial activity in the SE, including opportunity recognition and venture scaling. Startups engaged in orbital manufacturing and sustainable space practices exemplify how entrepreneurs create value in untested markets (Weinzierl & Sarang, 2021). Sustainability challenges—orbital debris management and reusable rocket technologies—align with TIM's interest in innovation governance and ONE's focus on environmental and ethical considerations (Peter, 2023). Additional contributions from OMT, OB, and SAP further enrich this interdisciplinary landscape, offering

insights into sensemaking, leadership, coordination, and real-time strategic practices in SE organizations operating under extreme technological, institutional, and temporal constraints. To reflect this breadth, the Appendix includes dedicated one-page relevance statements for each potential co-sponsoring division.

State of the Research:

As a frontier context, the SE is characterized by extreme uncertainty, capital intensity, dual-use constraints, long development horizons, and deep public–private interdependence: features that can expose mechanisms and boundary conditions less visible in terrestrial settings. To date, the SE context has received relatively little examination in strategy, entrepreneurship, and innovation research, with the existing contributions fragmented and limited in scope. This work has, for example, examined how institutional complexity and ecosystem-level interdependencies shape innovation in the small-satellite industry (Song et al., 2024), and how interdependencies among public and private actors influence coordination and technological development (Roy, 2025). Related work has explored early ecosystem formation and spatial dynamics in emerging industries (cf. Autio et al., 2018) and considered how global competition and capability formation are unfolding in commercial space markets (Raswant et al., 2025). These studies represent early instances of growing scholarly engagement with the SE. However, existing insights remain dispersed and topic-specific, with limited integration into broader theoretical debates in strategy, entrepreneurship, and innovation. What remains absent is an integrated perspective that articulates the conceptual implications of the SE as a whole and clarifies how its distinctive conditions can inform, refine, or extend existing theories. Building on the record-setting 2025 PDW and shifting from “introduction” to “consolidation,” the 2026 PDW addresses this gap by synthesizing emerging insights across domains and co-developing publication-oriented research designs and feasible data strategies through practitioner/academic panels and structured roundtables.

Extending the State-of-the-Art:

This PDW seeks to advance understanding of SE research by achieving two milestones. First, drawing insights from the keynote and the industry and academic panels, it integrates proposed research themes with theoretical perspectives, examining how existing theories can be adapted, extended, or recombined in the SE context. The academic panel plays a central role in translating practitioner insights into theoretically grounded questions and research directions. Second, through structured roundtable discussions, the PDW formulates propositions for empirical studies and data strategies that clarify these research categories, advancing academic and practical insights. Roundtables constitute the core interactive component of the PDW, each predefined by facilitators and devoted to specific SE research questions or challenges. Co-facilitated by 1–3 senior scholars, roundtables will feature targeted discussion questions, moderated dialogue, and synthesis captured by assigned note-takers. Roundtables are preceded by plenary pitches by facilitators, supporting informed participation and discussion. Participants will collaboratively develop actionable, publication-oriented research designs that shape the trajectory of SE scholarship. Together, these activities move the PDW toward consolidating and advancing a cumulative SE research agenda.

Summary of Goals and Expected Outcome:

This PDW aims to: (1) advance SE research by emphasizing key theoretical developments and consolidation opportunities; (2) highlight innovative methodologies and datasets; (3) address emerging phenomena and their implications for management research; and (4) explore practical and policy challenges in the SE, drawing insights from leading companies and agencies. The PDW will offer practitioner perspectives, interactive roundtables for co-creating research designs, and networking opportunities that support sustained scholarly collaboration. Outcomes include **a more integrated and forward-looking SE research agenda**, clearly articulated research questions and empirical strategies, opportunities for collaborative projects and edited collections, cross-divisional synergies, and a strengthened network of SE scholars.

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Table 1: Introduction to roundtables, facilitators, description, and key discussion points

Roundtable (1) Title: Entering the Space Economy: Emerging Business Models and New Roles for Non-Space Firms Facilitators: Lorenzo Massa, Antonio Messeni Petruzzelli, Esteve Almirall Mezquita, & Petteri Leppänen Description: The New Space Economy (NSE) is rapidly transforming the landscape of business and innovation, driven by novel business models that intersect space technologies, sustainability, and governance. Space, as a common-pool resource, presents unique challenges around managing shared access, ensuring long-term sustainability, and addressing issues of stewardship and legitimacy. At the same time, space is increasingly recognized not only as the locus of present and future commercial opportunities for space ventures, but also as an attractive domain for non-space companies—from sectors such as mobility, agriculture, energy, or digital services—seeking to leverage space-based data, infrastructure, or platforms. This roundtable aims to explore the emergence of new business models in the NSE: how they emerge, when they emerge, what types exist, and how sustainability and governance shape their evolution. We will further discuss how firms—both space-native and non-space—can participate in or transition into the space economy through innovative paths for creating, appropriating, and capturing value across the space ecosystem. Through this, we shed light on the dynamic shifts shaping this frontier for business model innovation and reflect on how these insights can enrich our understanding of business models in more traditional sectors. Key discussion points: • What makes space a distinctive domain for entrepreneurial and innovation activities beyond governance-of-the-commons challenges? • How can non-space firms enter and position themselves within the space economy? What roles, capabilities, business model configurations, and partnerships enable their participation? • What theoretical lenses and methods help study the emergence and evolution of space-related business models? • How can insights from space business models inform our understanding of “mainstream” business model innovation?
Roundtable (2) Title: Coopetition in the Space Economy: How Firms Collaborate and Compete Facilitators: Devi R. Gnyawali, Ken Davidian, & Yue Song Description: The space economy is characterized by a mix of cooperation and competition among firms, usually between the “Old Space” incumbents and “New Space” entrants. Firms frequently share launch infrastructure, standards, and ground networks while simultaneously competing in satellite manufacturing, data services, and downstream applications. This PDW roundtable examines how such coopetition shapes innovation trajectories, influences ecosystem emergence, and contributes to the development of the value proposition. Key discussion points: • To what extent do space firms pursue coopetition, or engage in simultaneous competition and cooperation with each other? • How does coopetition among space firms lead to the creation of mutual/joint value and firm/private value? How do firms balance them? • How does coopetition among space firms contribute to the development of the ecosystem value proposition?
Roundtable (3) Title: Phenomenon-Driven Research and Space Economy

Facilitators: Kevin Rockmann, Erkkö Autio, Yong Li, & Jeffrey Martin

Description: The space economy is an unusually fertile setting for phenomenon-driven research—work that begins with observing real-world transformations and puzzles rather than starting from “gaps” in existing literature. The sector combines extreme uncertainty, long development horizons, shifting public–private boundaries, dual-use considerations, and rapid technological and institutional change. These features create empirical puzzles that can outpace current theory and invite discovery-oriented inquiry. This roundtable will discuss how scholars can identify compelling space-economy phenomena, bound them appropriately (units, levels, and time windows), and translate rich empirical observations into credible empirical regularities and plausible explanations that speak to broader organization and strategy theory—without forcing premature theoretical closure.

Key discussion points:

- What makes the space economy particularly well-suited for phenomenon-driven and discovery-oriented research (versus “gap-spotting”)?
- How do we recognize and articulate a “good phenomenon” versus a context that is merely novel?
- How can researchers effectively immerse themselves in space-industry contexts (ventures, agencies, supply chains, regulators) to observe phenomena that challenge existing theories?
- What are effective ways to bound the phenomenon (unit/level of analysis, time windows, comparisons) in long-horizon, high-uncertainty settings?
- How can we move from descriptive richness to analytical clarity—i.e., from “interesting story” to a clear empirical regularity and plausible explanation?
- What methodological challenges are distinctive in space contexts (data sparsity, secrecy/dual-use constraints, event rarity), and what are pragmatic strategies for addressing them?
- What roles should engagement with practitioners, entrepreneurs, and policymakers play in shaping phenomenon-forward research questions and interpretations?
- What are promising underexplored phenomena for future research (e.g., hype and legitimacy dynamics, financing regimes, public–private partnerships, mission assurance/safety, standards and regulation, geopolitical shocks)?

Roundtable (4)

Title: Methodological Challenges for Management Scholars Exploring Space Economy

Facilitators: Michael John Gill & Markus Perkman

Description: This roundtable examines the distinctive methodological challenges and strategic research opportunities associated with studying the emerging space economy. Space-related activities unfold over long time horizons, involve complex technological and organizational interdependencies, and require coordination among multiple public and private actors operating across national and regulatory regimes. These characteristics limit the usefulness of snapshot research designs and call for approaches capable of capturing unfolding trajectories, ecosystem dynamics, and cross-regime variation. At the same time, management scholars studying space organizations face persistent data and access constraints due to security restrictions, defense-related confidentiality, and the early developmental stages of many ventures. Drawing on research experiences across established and emerging space contexts, the roundtable explores how scholars can adapt and extend existing methodological approaches—while leveraging increasingly rich secondary data sources such as mission records, regulatory filings, procurement documents, and policy statements—to advance theory development in strategy, innovation,

entrepreneurship, and organization studies. The session invites participants to reflect on how methodological choices shape what we can theorize about complex, capital-intensive, and opaque frontier industries.

Key discussion points:

- What makes the space economy a distinctive empirical context for management research in terms of time horizons, interdependence, and organizational complexity?
- How do the long-duration and evolving nature of space activities challenge conventional research designs in strategy, innovation, and organization studies?
- Which methodological approaches are most appropriate for studying unfolding processes, ecosystem dynamics, and cross-regime variation in the space economy?
- How can scholars navigate access constraints related to security, confidentiality, and defense-related activities while maintaining theoretical and empirical rigor?
- How can emerging secondary data sources (e.g., mission archives, regulatory filings, procurement and policy documents) be used to complement primary data and study change over time?
- How can methodological innovation in space economy research help refine or extend existing management theories?

Roundtable (5)

Title: Contractual Governance and Innovation in the Space Economy

Facilitators: Benn Lawson, Brian Squire, & Jens Roehrich

Description: Large projects in the space economy rely on complex interorganizational collaborations involving public and private actors across national boundaries. These collaborations face long development horizons, technological uncertainty, small-numbers bargaining, and geopolitical and national security concerns. As a result, designing effective contractual and organizational governance mechanisms is especially challenging. This roundtable examines how contractual governance in the space economy differs from other interorganizational settings, particularly in large and innovation-oriented projects. The discussion focuses on how contracts and governance structures can balance control and coordination, safeguarding and innovation, and public and private objectives in multi-party space collaborations.

Key discussion points:

- What makes contractual governance in space economy projects distinct?
- How do governance challenges differ in large, hybrid, and innovation-driven space collaborations?
- How can contracts balance safeguarding against hazards with promoting innovation and problem-solving?
- What roles do governments, universities, and firms play in governing space innovation ecosystems?
- How can governance address geopolitical, national security, and dual-use concerns?

Roundtable (6)

Title: Research Urgency & Environmental Responsibility in the Space Economy

Facilitators: Gideon Markman, Oksana Gerwe, & Mary Sully de Luque

Description: The space economy is rapidly transforming from a state-dominated domain into a complex ecosystem of commercial, scientific, and governmental actors operating beyond Earth's boundaries. This shift raises urgent research questions for management scholars, particularly around value creation, governance, and environmental responsibility in an extraterritorial context characterized by regulatory gaps, diffuse accountability, and limited monitoring. This roundtable aims to catalyze management research on the space economy by examining its unique challenges and opportunities, with a particular focus on sustainability and environmental stewardship. Drawing on

lessons from terrestrial sustainability and governance, participants will explore how organizations can balance commercial opportunities in space with responsible environmental practices, and how existing frameworks may need to be adapted for space operations.

Key discussion points:

- How can value creation in the space economy be measured, monetized, and optimized?
- What barriers—technological, regulatory, legal, and ethical—limit the growth and accessibility of the space economy?
- How should organizations extend environmental responsibility and sustainability practices to space activities?
- What lessons from Earth-based sustainability (e.g., ESG, circular economy, precautionary principles) apply to space operations, and where do they fall short?
- How can international cooperation, industry-led initiatives, and voluntary commitments support sustainable and enforceable space governance?

Roundtable (7)

Title: Orchestrating Polycentricity in Space Platform Ecosystems

Facilitators: Marin Jovanovic, Paolo Trucco, & Yueling Zhou

Description:

Imagine an in-space manufacturing venture that successfully completes a first mission with a single pharmaceutical partner, guaranteeing a specific improvement in crystal quality. On the next mission, three additional customers want to fly payloads and a new launch provider joins. What began as a tightly managed bilateral project suddenly becomes a space platform ecosystem (SPE): outcomes must still be guaranteed, but roles, decision rights, and governance now span several organizations and missions. Similar dynamics play out in terrestrial industrial contexts, such as industrial IoT or autonomous mining, when firms move from proofs-of-concept to fleets, multiple sites, and broader platform ecosystems. Building on such empirical patterns, this roundtable foregrounds the orchestration challenges of scaling space platform ecosystems, rather than the technical details of any specific technology. We focus on how platform leaders and key complementors coordinate, structure, and govern multi-actor systems in order to move from one-off pilots to scalable operations while offering outcome-based value propositions (e.g., guaranteed performance, uptime, or quality). Discussion will address how orchestrators define outcome-oriented roles and responsibilities, architect decision and control rights, design boundary resources (interfaces, standards, certification regimes), and stage the transition from tightly controlled, centripetal experimentation to more centrifugal, ecosystem-wide scaling. We will also discuss how early strategic alliances provide a setting in which these orchestration choices can be trialed on a smaller scale, allowing firms to learn from and about partners as they experiment with governance and coordination routines. The overarching aim is to identify and compare orchestration practices—spanning governance, capability development, alliance-based learning, and value-capture arrangements—that enable space platform ecosystems to scale without losing coherence, accountability, or innovation capacity.

Five discussion points

- Which orchestration levers are most effective for aligning value creation and value capture as platform ecosystems co-evolve with market formation?
- What phasing of orchestration (from experimentation to replication and diversification) helps platforms transition from bespoke pilots to repeatable “playbooks” and, ultimately, large-scale ecosystem deployment?
- How should orchestrators adapt their governance approaches as ecosystems become more polycentric—that is, as new hubs, partners, or regulators gain influence and scaling becomes less centrally controlled?
- How do actors configure portfolios of alliances and integration moves (horizontal and vertical), and how do these strategic choices interact to shape capability development and ecosystem growth?

- How do alliances serve as capability-building mechanisms for orchestrators, and which alliance-derived learnings (relational, technical, and governance-related) are most critical for successful ecosystem scaling?

Roundtable (8)

Title: From International to Space Business? The Emerging New Space Economy and International Business Thought and Practice

Facilitators: Sebastian Herbert Fuchs & Tim Vorley

Description: International business theory and human activity in outer space roughly took off at the same time in the early 1960s. Early IB theory was built on FDI, trade theory, the MNC as focal IB-actor, and the internationalization process of business activity; Old Space was dominated by government and public agency driven exploration activity, and some contracting of private suppliers to enable such activities. However, retrospectively, it would have been sensible to already include considerations on space and its role for international business from the outset into international business thought. Today, IB is integrating outfield developments, such as digitalization and sustainability, to advance international business theory further. New Space, as an emerging private business engagement in low earth orbit offers the possibility to reconsider the roots and self-conception of IB as a research field and business practice in a new light.

Key discussion points:

- How can IB theory accommodate for market creation via New Space activities in contrast to traditional internationalization thought?
- How can space value chain governance challenges be aligned with the institutional challenges of space?
- Is there a need for a new role of IB in the scholarly community, given the increased interdisciplinary that New Space activities command?
- Will IB be integrative for all management thought or be a context element for other management disciplines?
- IB must not stand on the sidelines: What has IB to offer for New Space practitioners? And how can IB be closer to New Space business?
- How do entrepreneurial opportunity recognition and realization work for New Space business entrepreneurs?
- How can internationalization into space be sold internally in firms?

Roundtable (9)

Title: Opportunity Formation under Institutional Constraint: Insights from Space Entrepreneurship

Facilitators: Xaver Neumeyer, Raj Mahto, Donald Kuratko, & Jeffery S. McMullen

This roundtable explores how emerging ventures in the New Space economy navigate—and often attempt to reshape—the institutional and regulatory forces that define this rapidly evolving field. Although the sector is rich in technological opportunity, entrepreneurial action is tightly intertwined with national space agencies, defense actors, international treaties, and a patchwork of commercial and public–private governance structures. These institutional arrangements influence opportunity recognition, legitimacy building, financing, and access to critical technologies and data. The session invites participants to consider how entrepreneurs both adapt to and strategically engage with these institutional forces as markets and value chains take shape. By centering the institutional–entrepreneurial interface, the discussion highlights how existing theories of entrepreneurship and institutions may need to be rethought for frontier industries where ventures and institutions co-construct the field.

Key Discussion Points:

- How do entrepreneurs navigate institutional voids in areas like launch licensing, debris regulation, or satellite spectrum allocation?

- Under what conditions can space ventures influence institutional rules—for example, through partnerships, lobbying, or standard-setting?
- How should theory account for the co-evolution of institutions and entrepreneurial activity in frontier technological domains?

Roundtable (10)

Title: Beyond Capitalist Realism in New Space: How Can Alternative Organizational Forms Challenge Dominant Structures in the Space Economy?

Facilitators: Marc Ventresca, Gemma Milne, & Felix Honecker

Description: The New Space sector promises democratization yet remains bound by institutional constraints that privilege venture capital-backed, IP-concentrated, market-driven organizational forms. This roundtable explores tensions between technological imagination and political imagination in space entrepreneurship. While visions of multi-planetary futures abound, genuinely transformative organizational approaches – commoning, cooperative ownership, open innovation, participatory governance – struggle to gain legitimacy and support. Drawing on institutional theory, organization studies, and critical performativity, we examine how competing institutional logics create both constraints and possibilities for alternative organizational models. Rather than offering predictable critique, participants will engage with the practical question of how management scholarship can support diverse, inclusive organizational forms that work to deliver on the SE's democratization promises.

Key Discussion Points:

- What mechanisms insulate dominant organizational forms in New Space from critique while marginalizing alternatives, and how might CMS scholars engage performatively to challenge these dynamics?
- How can concepts of prefigurative politics and alternative organizations inform the development of space ventures that embody different social relations, ownership structures, and governance models?
- What role does excessive future-oriented discourse focused on risk and investability play in limiting organizational imagination, and how might this constitute a form of ideological closure?
- What interventionist or collaborative research approaches can management scholars adopt to support entrepreneurs, policymakers, and advocacy groups working to create genuinely transformative organizational alternatives in space?

Roundtable (11)

Title: Open and Multi-Actor Innovation in the Space Economy

Facilitators: Marc Gruber, Magdalena Marczevska, & Tamara Roth

Description: The space economy is transitioning from a state-dominated sector to a complex innovation ecosystem involving public agencies, aerospace incumbents, startups, platform providers, scientific communities, and open-source contributors. As activities such as satellite development, space tourism, and off-planet resource exploration expand, innovation increasingly depends on collaboration across organizational, sectoral, and community boundaries. This roundtable explores how open innovation practices, digital platforms, and ecosystem strategies shape the development and commercialization of space technologies. Participants will discuss how public–private and community-based collaboration can accelerate innovation, manage technological risk, and influence value creation, governance, and sustainability in the space economy.

Key discussion points:

- How can open innovation approaches support high-risk R&D and commercialization in the space economy?
- How do public agencies, private firms, and communities coordinate innovation across ecosystems and platforms?
- How does growing private-sector participation reshape ecosystem dynamics, value creation, and competition in orbit?
- What new organizational forms and governance mechanisms emerge to support multi-actor space innovation?
- What lessons from terrestrial industries can inform sustainable, inclusive, and strategically managed innovation in space?

Roundtable (12)

Title: Social Issues in the Space Economy

Facilitators: Nien-hê Hsieh & Tony Guidotti

Description: The Space Economy (SE) raises important questions pertaining to social issues in management and international business, which warrant further discussion. In this roundtable, we will explore the global, social and ethical impacts of the SE, particularly as they pertain to public private partnerships, ownership models and governance within the space sector. The SE has historically relied upon scientific and diplomatic cooperation, however, has also been met by moments of contestation, for example during the Cold War. In light of growing geopolitical tension, ambiguous and ill-defined property rights in the context of Space and the growing presence of multinational enterprises (MNEs) (Raswant et al., 2025), there remains scope to understand how different actors may advance responsible business conduct in Space. Therefore, this roundtable aims to contribute to the scholarly conversation by exploring the potential social and ethical implications and opportunities of the SE, by building upon the ownership, location and internationalization (OLI) framework put forth by Dunning (1973), and adapted to the context of the SE by Raswant & colleagues (2025). The discussion will explore ownership models within the SE, particularly as they relate to the global commons, and will consider distributional aspects inherent to space sustainability, responsible innovation and global cooperation and partnership.

Key discussion points:

- How can ownership models for the SE advance governance that considers distributional aspects for the global commons? What might these models look like?
- How can we envision global cooperation and partnership when moving from geopolitics to astropolitics, in the age of corporate diplomacy?
- What might responsible innovation look like in the context of the SE? What ethical and distributional impacts are important to consider, from research and development to global supply chains and implementation?

Table 2: Schedule, process, and specifics of each PDW component

<i>Time</i>	<i>Specifics of each PDW component</i>
(0:00–0:10)	1. Introduction and Overview ○ Brief welcome and orientation to the PDW. ○ Introduction to the Space Economy (SE) and the objectives of the 2026 PDW. ○ Overview of the session structure (keynote, panels, roundtables) and emphasis on consolidating a cumulative research agenda.
(0:10–0:55)	2. Keynote Address ○ Distinguished industry keynote speaker provides an overview of the evolving Space Economy and emerging managerial, organizational, and innovation challenges. ○ Keynote sets the empirical and strategic context for subsequent panels and roundtable discussions. ○ Dedicated audience Q&A session enables participants to engage directly with the keynote speaker and explore implications for management research.
(0:55–1:40)	3. Industry Practitioner Panel ○ Moderated panel session, beginning with brief introductions of panelists from pioneering space companies (e.g., Axiom, Voyager, VAST). ○ Each panelist responds to two curated questions designed to surface key challenges in the SE. ○ Panelists share practitioner perspectives on innovation, governance, ecosystem coordination, and scaling challenges in the SE. ○ Structured audience Q&A allows participants to ask questions, clarify practitioner perspectives, and explore implications for management research.
(1:40–2:25)	4. Academic Panel ○ Moderated panel session, beginning with brief introductions of senior-scholar academic panelists from relevant AOM divisions. ○ Each panelist responds to two curated questions focused on theory development, research design, and methodological approaches for studying the SE. ○ Academic panelist discuss how practitioner insights can inform theory development, research questions, and methodological approaches. ○ This panel bridges the keynote and industry panel insights with the subsequent roundtable discussions. ○ Structured audience Q&A provides participants with opportunities to ask questions.
(2:25–3:30)	5. Roundtable Pitches and Interactive Roundtable Discussions ○ Brief plenary pitches by roundtable facilitators outlining predefined research themes and guiding questions (Table 1). ○ Participants transition to roundtables aligned with their preregistered thematic preferences. ○ Each roundtable, led by 2–4 academic facilitators, focuses on co-creating research designs, identifying data sources, and articulating theoretical contributions related to the SE. ○ Discussions emphasize actionable research ideas and opportunities for collaboration. ○ Discussions further emphasize cross-divisional collaboration, refinement of propositions, and development of research agendas.

Table 3: List of PDW’s committed participants (organizers, facilitators, and participants in alphabetical order)

#	<i>Name</i>	<i>Affiliation</i>	<i>Research focus related to Space economy</i>
1	Enrique Acebo	University of León	Entrepreneurship/innovation & sustainability
2	Ron Adner	Tuck School of Business at Dartmouth	Innovation ecosystems; ecosystem strategy; value creation & competitive advantage across ecosystems
3	Esteve Almirall Mezquita	ESADE Business School	New business models for startups; nanosatellites; Space IoT
4	Francisca Alvarez Figueroa	Alliance Manchester Business School, University of Manchester	Employment studies / HRM; equality, diversity & inclusion; labor and organizational outcomes
5	Abhishek Behl	Keele Business School, Keele University	Digital platforms / IT, analytics; “dark side” of tech
6	Janet Lee Elsie Bercovitz	Leeds School of Business, University of Colorado, Boulder	Contracting/Governance; Innovation; University-Industry Technology Transfer
7	Elettra D'Amico	Politecnico di Torino	New Space Economy startups; founding team characteristics in New Space; entrepreneurial ecosystems
8	Ken Davidian	Virginia Tech & Impossible Research LLC	Process research; industry emergence; organizational change; innovation
9	Kathleen Eisenhardt	Stanford University	Strategy; organization theory; entrepreneurship; innovation; theory building
10	Zouheir El Kawas	Toulouse School of Management	Strategy & international management
11	Sebastian Herbert Fuchs	Tecnologico de Monterrey, Oxford Brookes Business School	International business theory; internationalization theory; space value chains
12	Fredrik Hacklin	ETH Zurich	Entrepreneurship / corporate innovation; innovation management; convergence in innovation
13	Carlo Giglio	University of Calabria	Innovation; entrepreneurship
14	Oksana Gerwe	University College London (UCL)	Strategic management; entrepreneurship; innovation
15	Nien-hê Hsieh	Harvard Business School	Business ethics; corporate responsibility & human rights; global justice / political philosophy in business
16	Michael John Gill	Saïd Business School, University of Oxford	Qualitative and Process Methods; Qualitative Methods; Process Research
17	Devi R. Gnyawali	Virginia Tech	Coopetition; ecosystem; innovation

18	Sanjeev Gordhan	Type One Ventures	Venture capital; startup scaling & operations; strategic growth; investment in frontier/deep tech
19	Marc Gruber	École Polytechnique Fédérale de Lausanne (EPFL)	Entrepreneurship & technology commercialization; new venture creation; innovation/entrepreneurial strategy
20	Tony Guidotti	Harvard Business School	Business ownership models; economic dignity & justice; community wealth building
21	Brad Handerson	Starlab Space	Commercial strategy; partnerships & business development; revenue growth / go-to-market
22	Felix Honecker	University of Glasgow	Organization studies / alternative forms & governance in frontier industries
23	Marin Jovanovic	Copenhagen Business School (CBS)	Platform business models; platform ecosystems; digital servitization; human–AI collaboration/orchestration
24	Ameek Kaur	National University of Singapore	Management of technology education; design-based learning; design thinking; learning from failure; failure tolerance & innovativeness
25	Donald Kuratko	Indiana University	Entrepreneurship; corporate entrepreneurship; innovation; entrepreneurial ecosystems
26	Stefan Korber	University of Auckland	Entrepreneurship; innovation; entrepreneurial ecosystems
27	Benn Lawson	Saïd Business School, University of Oxford	Supply chain management; strategic sourcing; operations management
28	Petteri Leppänen	IE Business School	Novel strategies; innovation; organizational learning
29	Yuan Li	Saint Mary's College of California	Organization theory; Rhetoric & semiotics of change; Institutional & technological change
30	Marta Lindvert	Nord University	Space entrepreneurship / space industry development
31	Yong Li	University of Nevada, Las Vegas	Strategy; entrepreneurship; international business; venture capital; crowdfunding; new venture innovation
32	Lucie Low	Axiom Space	Microgravity research & manufacturing; commercial space stations; LEO research infrastructure; commercial SE development & research partnerships
33	William Luse	University of La Verne	Careers; organizational justice; individual differences; groups / teams; conflict management / negotiation

34	Raj Mahto	University of New Mexico	Entrepreneurship; Resource Orchestration; Firm Growth
35	Gideon Markman	Colorado State University	Property Rights Theory; Resource Extraction; New Theories
36	Magdalena Marczevska	University of Warsaw & Indiana University	Innovation and technology management; digital strategy; space economy
37	Jeffrey Martin	University of Alabama	Industry emergence; Innovation ecosystems; Strategic adaptation
38	Lorenzo Massa	Aalborg University Business School	Business model innovation; business models for sustainability; science entrepreneurship
39	Catherine McDonald	University of St. Gallen	Business ethics; business & human rights; corporate diplomacy; corporate responsibility in conflict-affected settings
40	Jeffery S. McMullen	Imperial College Business School	Entrepreneurial action and judgment; entrepreneurial uncertainty; opportunity institutions and entrepreneurship
41	Juergen Meissner	Kühne Logistics University (KLU)	Operations / analytics; pricing & revenue management; decision models
42	Gemma Milne	University of Glasgow	Political economy of emerging tech (incl. space); tech narratives / hype; deep-tech innovation & society
43	Marco Minciullo	Università Cattolica del Sacro Cuore	CSR / sustainability & governance
44	Mehdi Montakhabi	Saïd Business School, University of Oxford	Nascent sectors; platforms ecosystems; space economy
45	Clay Mowry	IAF & AIAA	Space-industry leadership; commercial space ecosystems; space policy / international space community
46	Mayukh Mukhopadhyay	Indian Institute of Management Indore	Blockchain & smart contracts; NFTs / digital assets; quantitative finance / market microstructure; nostalgia marketing; marketing communications & consumer behavior
47	Xaver Neumeyer	University of New Mexico	Entrepreneurship; entrepreneurial ecosystems; innovation; poverty / inclusion; digital literacy
48	Terry Pagan	NASA Ames Research Center	Space innovation partnerships / stakeholder engagement
49	Antonio Messeni Petruzzelli	Polytechnic University of Bari	Business model; open innovation; industry emergence
50	Markus Perkman	Imperial College Business School	Science commercialization; corporate entrepreneurship; collaboration between start-ups and established corporations

51	Andreas Raspotnik	Fridtjof Nansen Institute	Space governance / policy
52	Ryan Reel	Outpost Space	Space logistics; orbital infrastructure; in-space transportation
53	Jens Roehrich	University of Bath	Supply chains; ecosystem; public-private relationships; governance
54	Kevin Rockmann	George Mason University	Work relationships & identity; teams; remote/hybrid work and organizing
55	Tamara Roth	University of Arkansas	Digital innovation; organizational sensemaking; blockchain / digital identity; qualitative / behavioral research
56	Elie Saad	Umeå University	Entrepreneurship; innovation intermediaries; corporate governance; resilience in crisis
57	Johannes Schmied-Wirén	Nord University	Emergency / crisis management; decision-making under complexity; knowledge transfer
58	Yue Song	San Diego State University	Ecosystems; small satellites network; innovation
59	Brian Squire	University of Bristol	Supply chain management; operations management
60	Mary Sully de Luque	Thunderbird School of Global Management, Arizona State University	Cross-cultural leadership; responsible leadership/CSR; organizational behavior
61	Piotr Staszkiwicz	Warsaw School of Economics	Audit; assurance; insolvency
62	Iselin Kristine Mauseth Steira	Nord University Business School	Entrepreneurship & venture teams; entrepreneurship education
63	Felipe Symmes	EGADE Business School, Tecnológico de Monterrey	Entrepreneurship; organizational imagination/market creation
64	Christopher Tucci	Imperial College Business School	Digital strategy & innovation; digital business models; platforms & ecosystems; AI/data-driven innovation
65	Paolo Trucco	Politecnico di Milano (School of Management)	Risk/resilience & safety in complex socio-technical systems; project / operations risk
66	Beverly Tyler	Virginia Tech	Contracting; large projects; interorganizational alliances
67	Marc Ventresca	Saïd Business School, University of Oxford	Organization theory; innovation; smart space
68	Tim Vorley	Oxford Brookes Business School	Economic geography; social sciences; policy
69	Andrea Wang	INSEAD	Organizational / social networks; inequality in network advantage; gender & minority differences in networks
70	Jinmin Wang	University of Nottingham	Innovation; entrepreneurship

71	Matthew Weinzierl	Harvard Business School (HBS)	Economics of space; space policy & regulation; public economics / policy design applied to commercial space
72	Valentina Zancan	Politecnico di Milano (School of Management)	Project / technology management & governance in complex programs
73	Luis Zea	Starlab Space	Space biology; gravitational microbiology; microgravity research platforms
74	Yueling Zhou	Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam	Strategy / alliances; learning in alliances
75	Maurizio Zollo	Imperial College Business School	Sustainability; alliances; mergers and acquisitions

APPENDIX I: RELEVANCE TO SUPPORTING DIVISIONS

RELEVANCE TO THE STR DIVISION

The SE is creating novel competitive landscapes across aerospace/defense, telecommunications, and adjacent industries (OECD, 2020), making it a timely setting for STR research on competitive advantage, technological change, and industry evolution. Technological advances such as satellite miniaturization and reusable launch systems have lowered entry barriers and accelerated experimentation by incumbents and new entrants, alongside growing investor attention (OECD, 2023; WEF & McKinsey, 2024). For STR scholars, the SE sharpens classic questions about industry emergence: when rivalry, standardization, and co-opetition coexist rather than unfold sequentially, and how these patterns shape dominant designs and ecosystem stability (Song et al., 2024). It is also a fertile context for extending capability-based perspectives under high uncertainty and irreversibility (Teece, 2007), how dynamic capabilities operate in turbulent settings (Eisenhardt & Martin, 2000), and how managerial cognition steers strategic change amid technological discontinuities (Tripsas & Gavetti, 2000; Helfat & Martin, 2015). Many SE firms depend on combining market and non-market strategies while positioning within interdependent ecosystems, where SE can refine theory on ecosystem strategy and value capture under institutional complexity (Adner, 2017; Manotti et al., 2025). The SE's entrepreneurial ecosystems (agencies, primes, platform firms, and startups) foreground STR issues of alliance governance, asymmetric dependence, and intellectual property in collaborative innovation (Agostini & Nosella, 2019; Chen et al., 2024). High-profile setbacks (e.g., the 2014 Virgin Galactic test flight crash) underscore the strategic importance of resilience, learning, and risk governance in extreme contexts (Chai et al., 2022). Finally, expanding public and commercial data sources create opportunities and methodological challenges for studying strategy in frontier industries (Rottner, 2019; Roy & Chaudhuri, 2021; Song et al., 2024). The PDW aims to translate these phenomena into research designs, clarifying constructs and boundary conditions and identifying feasible data and methods for theory-building and testing.

RELEVANCE TO THE ENT DIVISION

The SE has shifted from a predominantly state-led arena to a frontier market in which startups, incumbents, and agencies jointly build technologies, standards, and demand (WEF & McKinsey, 2024). For ENT scholars, the SE is a distinctive empirical setting that foregrounds entrepreneurial action under extreme uncertainty, high capital intensity, long development horizons, and pervasive dual-use constraints; conditions that sharpen core debates on opportunity creation versus discovery and entrepreneurial judgment under uncertainty (Alvarez & Barney, 2007; McMullen & Shepherd, 2006). Because technical and financial bets are often large and difficult to reverse, the SE makes visible how entrepreneurs commit early, learn under constrained experimentation, and sustain credibility when failure can be binary rather than incremental. The SE is also a natural laboratory for entrepreneurial ecosystems and market construction. Ecosystems form through coordinated investments among launch providers, satellite manufacturers, data-platform firms, prime contractors, regulators, venture capital, and accelerators, often in hybrid public-private arrangements that structure entry, scaling, and value capture (Robinson & Mazzucato, 2019; Autio et al., 2018). Because architectures are tightly coupled and certification/procurement can be gatekept, founders must mobilize complementary assets, negotiate dependencies, and coordinate roles before markets and governance regimes stabilize, offering a high-resolution setting for theorizing ecosystem emergence, power asymmetries, and institutional evolution (Song et al., 2024). Finally, space entrepreneurship increasingly targets grand challenges (e.g., climate monitoring and connectivity equity), inviting ENT research on responsible innovation and the uneven distribution of benefits and risks (George et al., 2016). The PDW aims to help participants translate these frontier dynamics into research designs, clarifying constructs, boundary conditions, and feasible data strategies for studying entrepreneurship in the SE.

RELEVANCE TO THE IM DIVISION

The SE is an inherently international domain: missions, infrastructures, and value chains span jurisdictions, cultures, and regulatory regimes, while strategic rivalry coexists with sustained cross-border collaboration. From early cooperative programs to contemporary multinational initiatives (e.g., Artemis and other lunar exploration efforts), the SE has repeatedly required coordination across states, agencies, and firms, even under geopolitical tension (Jenks, 2022; Peeters & Ehrenfreund, 2025). As commercialization accelerates, private actors and multinational enterprises (MNEs) increasingly shape how space-based capabilities are financed, governed, and integrated into terrestrial markets and global supply chains (Nielsen, Wechtler, & Zheng, 2023; Raswant et al., 2025). For the IM Division, the SE offers a high salience setting to advance core international management questions under unusually sharp boundary conditions. Space-based activities combine fragmented regulation, dual-use sensitivities, and evolving standards with ambiguous property-rights and liability arrangements; conditions that complicate contracting, location choices, knowledge transfer, and legitimacy-building across borders (Raswant et al., 2025). These features enable IM scholars to examine how MNEs configure and govern international R&D alliances, manage cross-border ecosystem interdependence (agencies, primes, startups, platforms), and navigate institutional complexity when “distance” is simultaneously geographic, political, and technological. The SE is also theoretically consequential for IM because it invites refinement of foundational IB frameworks. Classic internalization and OLI-style logics can be probed where irreversibility is high, coordination is multi-party, and governance is shaped by evolving international arrangements and national policy divergence (Dunning, 1980). The PDW aims to convene scholars to translate these distinctive features into research designs on IM topics such as internationalization into frontier domains, cross-border governance of emerging ecosystems, and the co-evolution of global institutions and firm strategy in the SE.

RELEVANCE TO THE ONE DIVISION

The SE's rapid growth brings significant sustainability challenges. Orbital debris is crowding space, posing critical threats to operational safety. For ONE scholars, the SE is a distinctive empirical setting because it foregrounds the governance of a global common-pool resource and the risk of "tragedy of the commons" dynamics in orbit (Ostrom, 1990; Dietz et al., 2003). The near-evacuation of the International Space Station due to collision risks underscores the need for effective governance. Negative externalities from rocket launches persist, and end-of-life satellite management remains uneven and contested. Recent ESA estimates suggest that tens of thousands of debris objects are in orbit, and collisions can generate fragments that further escalate congestion and risk. Yet, promising developments offer hope: reusable rocket technologies may reduce environmental impacts (Paladini et al., 2021) and startups are attracting funding with commitments to sustainable space practices (Paravano et al., 2024). Governance initiatives also illustrate both progress and gaps, including ESA's Zero Debris Charter (2023), a voluntary commitment aiming to reduce debris generation by 2030, and regulatory efforts (e.g., the FCC's post-mission disposal "5-year" approach) intended to accelerate deorbiting and limit long-lived debris. These efforts position firms and agencies as potential architects of polycentric governance: building partial "rules of the road" where comprehensive enforcement remains difficult. However, research lags behind these innovations. There is still lack of clarity on applying Earth-based sustainability principles to space and on how lessons from space can inform broader environmental governance. Unlike many terrestrial commons where boundaries, monitoring, and sanctioning can be institutionalized locally, orbital space faces weak excludability and limited supranational enforcement; an extreme case for testing and extending commons-governance theory and corporate environmental responsibility. The PDW aims to develop publishable research designs on ONE topics such as (1) debris and end-of-life governance, (2) accountability and enforcement under diffuse harms and partial monitoring, and (3) diffusion of sustainability innovations and standards across interdependent ecosystems.

RELEVANCE TO THE OMT DIVISION

The SE provides a novel and high-stakes context for OMT research on how organizations construct meaning, coordinate action, and adapt under ambiguity (Weick, 1995; Gioia & Chittipeddi, 1991). Public and private actors navigating new technological, regulatory, and operational challenges must simultaneously interpret emergent complexities and shape stakeholders' perceptions. Space organizations can face “cosmological episodes” (Weick, 1995) that disrupt taken-for-granted assumptions and trigger rapid reframing, sensemaking, and learning (Maitlis & Christianson, 2014). This makes the SE particularly well-suited for OMT work on multilevel sensemaking across diverse expert communities and on how sensegiving practices shape legitimacy, investment, and policy support. Beyond ambiguity, the SE is increasingly shaped by structural shifts that raise core OMT questions about governance and organizing. Geopolitical dynamics are accelerating transitions from civil to dual-use and defense-oriented projects, intensifying tensions between openness and secrecy, collaboration and control, and speed and mission assurance. At the same time, narratives of a more democratized “New Space” coexist with market concentration by national agencies and dominant technology firms, creating uneven dependencies and new legitimacy pressures for smaller firms and startups. In parallel, the integration of AI into development and operations introduces paradoxes of automation versus augmentation, potentially reshaping task complexity, improvisation, and accountability in ways that extend classic perspectives on organizing in real time (Weick, 1998). These conditions point to hybrid governance arrangements, neither purely market-based nor fully centralized, where actors attempt to steer trajectories through standards, contracts, platforms, and policy coalitions. The PDW aims to enable participants to develop publishable research designs on OMT topics such as: (1) multilevel sense-making/giving and competing narratives across stakeholders; (2) governance hybridity, boundary work, and shifting organizational forms across public–private and civil–defense domains; and (3) how new technologies (including AI) reconfigure coordination, accountability, and resilience in complex, interdependent systems.

RELEVANCE TO THE OB DIVISION

Organizations in the Space Economy (SE) operate in extreme, safety-critical, reliability-demanding environments where small coordination failures can have outsized consequences. This makes the SE a compelling context for OB scholars studying how individuals and teams perform, learn, and remain resilient under pressure. Space organizations must recruit and train highly specialized talent, coordinate tightly coupled technical work, and sustain well-being through long development cycles punctuated by time-critical operations. At the team level, the SE is well suited for examining psychological safety and speaking up (Edmondson, 1999), particularly when expertise is distributed across disciplines, sites, and partner organizations. It also foregrounds how leadership roles and influence shift as missions evolve, consistent with functional views of leadership in teams (Morgeson et al., 2010), and how coordination is achieved when urgency and uncertainty are persistent features of the work (Faraj & Xiao, 2006). These conditions spotlight trade-offs between experimentation, discipline, and safety. The SE also sharpens OB questions about culture and identity in organizations that blend entrepreneurial speed with public accountability and, increasingly, dual-use and security constraints. Such hybrid demands can reshape incentive systems, communication norms, and risk perceptions, opening avenues to study motivation, trust, role conflict, and collaboration across public–private boundaries. This PDW supports OB by helping participants develop publishable research designs on: (1) resilience, well-being, and sustained performance in high-stakes project environments; (2) leadership, expertise, and teamwork in distributed, expert-intensive settings; and (3) coordination and learning across organizational boundaries in complex, interdependent ecosystems. Together, these themes position the SE as a laboratory for extending OB theory on adaptation, collaboration, and performance in uncertain, high-technology conditions.

RELEVANCE TO THE CTO DIVISION

The SE is catalyzing a new wave of digital transformation as firms increasingly rely on space-derived data and services for business intelligence and operational decision-making (Bruckardt, 2022). This shift is evident in rising organizational attention and investment in space-enabled capabilities, as technology leaders assess how space data and infrastructure can create competitive advantage (Otto et al., 2022). The SE is a timely empirical setting to examine how organizations build and reconfigure capabilities across people, process, and technology; including upskilling, governance routines, and integration architectures that connect space-based inputs with existing digital stacks (Punnala et al., 2025). The SE is extending business ecosystems into orbital environments, where digital infrastructures must operate under tight constraints and with limited direct human intervention. Illustrative developments include orbital data centers using solar power and vacuum cooling to support sustainable compute, satellite operators leasing capacity to expand global connectivity, and experiments using satellites to support blockchain decentralization (Kmieliauskas, 2023). These cases foreground CTO questions about how platforms and infrastructures evolve when terrestrial systems become interdependent with autonomous, space-based components. The SE also intensifies CTO challenges such as technological diffusion and commercialization from experimentation to scalable deployment; coordination across public-private partnerships; and governance shaped by interoperability, regulatory alignment, and international collaboration. Finally, the SE raises ethical, social, and institutional questions about responsible innovation: how sustainability, accessibility, and accountability are designed into shared digital infrastructures whose benefits/risks are unevenly distributed (Bruckardt, 2022). In the PDW, CTO members will work with facilitators to translate these issues into research designs, including tractable constructs, boundary conditions, and feasible data strategies.

RELEVANCE TO THE OSCM DIVISION

The SE presents a compelling context for OSCM scholars. It introduces challenges ranging from ensuring resilience amid unprecedented environmental uncertainties (Pettit et al., 2010) to managing supply networks for extraterrestrial operations. The distinctive characteristics of SE open new research pathways in OSCM, including sourcing critical materials, managing fleets of orbiting satellites, coordinating partnerships, and mitigating risks related to debris and geopolitical tensions (Paladini et al., 2021; Peter, 2023). Existing OSCM knowledge can be adapted to SE, such as applying supply chain design and optimization approaches like route optimization and inventory management. However, SE imposes unique constraints, including launch schedules, orbital trajectories, and signal latencies. As launch cadences and space operations increase, aligning space-based and terrestrial supply chains becomes critical. This raises questions about how standardized processes can reduce interoperability issues, real-time data sharing can bridge terrestrial and orbital decision-making, and governance models can manage public-private stakeholder dynamics. CSM tools, including supplier co-innovation processes and evaluation techniques, offer additional opportunities for application. Insights from existing SCM discourse (e.g., Roscoe et al., 2022) can inform these actions. Sustainable operations also hold potential, as life-cycle assessment and circular economy approaches can evaluate and redesign the environmental impact of spacecraft manufacturing, launches, and operations. Space also redefines manufacturing possibilities. Technologies like 3D printing enable on-demand production in orbit or on planetary surfaces, reducing the need to carry spare parts. SE also foregrounds closed-loop operations (i.e., maintenance, refurbishment, and end-of-life planning for space assets) creating a test bed for circular supply chains under extreme constraints. Emerging concepts such as in-situ resource utilization extend classic OSCM questions about sourcing, inventory positioning, and process design into off-Earth settings. In the PDW, OSCM members will work with facilitators to translate these operational challenges into research designs, clarifying focal phenomena, units of analysis, and data strategies.

RELEVANCE TO THE CMS DIVISION

Despite promises of democratization and transformative innovation, the Space Economy (SE) presents a critical arena for examining power structures, institutional logics, and market rationalities. Space has become a site for capital accumulation and entrenchment of tech-oligarchic power in the surveillance, land-grab, and conflict-shaping practices of private actors, seen for example in Elon Musk's role in the Ukraine-Russia war and in SpaceX's contested operations on Indigenous and environmentally-protected land (Roulette et al., 2025; Wray, 2021). The Artemis Accords and the Commercial Space Launch Competitiveness Act have privatized the global commons of the 1960s Outer Space Treaty (Jones, 2021; Milne, 2020). The logics of extractive frontiers and geopolitical sovereignty are evident in space mining proposals and reliance on satellite data, with associated waste and debris affecting the climate and local communities (Damjanov, 2017; Chinigò & Walker, 2020; Bennett, 2022). And the tensions between technological imagination and constrained political possibility appear in retrofuturism, technosolutionist, and libertarian-utopic ideologies about what the SE is and who it is for (Tutton, 2021; Daniel, 2023; Chalmers et al., 2025; Deberdt & Le Billon, 2023; Tabas, 2025). This PDW offers CMS scholars an opportunity to move beyond "predictable" critique (Spicer & Alvesson, 2025) and engage with an empirical setting where struggles over organizational futures remain open. The SE exemplifies CMS themes including alternative organizations (Parker et al., 2014), control and resistance in emerging industries (Fleming & Spicer, 2007), and the commercialization of research under neoliberalism (Irzık, 2007; Baines & Hager, 2024). For scholars committed to performative and prefigurative engagement (Spicer et al., 2009; Monticelli 2022), this PDW provides a forum to examine the SE as a laboratory for understanding whether emerging industries can enact genuinely transformative alternatives or reproduce dominant managerialist forms.

RELEVANCE TO THE DEI DIVISION

The SE is an unusually consequential setting for DEI scholarship as it combines frontier, expert-intensive work and “mission” narratives with project-based organizing, security/regulatory constraints, and concentrated control over infrastructure and standards. This combination creates a fertile context for examining how inequality is produced and legitimized in real time; through hiring and credentialing, access to stretch assignments, sponsorship, performance evaluation, and whose risk concerns and expertise are treated as credible. Classic DEI questions about inclusion and voice are sharpened in the SE because work often unfolds under tight coupling and high consequence, where speaking up, dissent, and error reporting are essential, but also socially risky, forms of participation. The SE also foregrounds how inequality is structured across interorganizational ecosystems. Space activity is coordinated through layered supply chains and public–private partnerships, where “core” actors (agencies, primes, dominant platform firms) set technical interfaces, procurement rules, and compliance regimes that shape opportunities for peripheral firms, contractors, and workers. This ecosystem perspective enables DEI research on how power and dependency travel across organizational boundaries and how diversity and inclusion commitments translate or fail to translate, across contracting, subcontracting, and global production networks. Finally, the SE has a distinctly transnational dimension that makes questions of global equity and epistemic authority unavoidable. Participation in governance, access to orbital resources, and influence over standards and rule-setting remain unevenly distributed across states and corporations. A DEI lens can interrogate who is recognized as a legitimate stakeholder, whose knowledge counts in decisions about safety, sustainability, and access, and how inclusion is negotiated when the institutional field itself is still consolidating. The PDW provides DEI scholars with a forum to develop research designs on DEI topics such as (1) inclusion, voice, and psychological safety in high-stakes technical work; (2) intersectional career dynamics and leadership pathways in project-based and partner-heavy organizations; and (3) equity and inclusion across ecosystems, where governance choices can lock in (or disrupt) inequality early in an industry’s formation.

RELEVANCE TO THE HR DIVISION

Over the past decades, the SE has shifted from a government-dominated sector to a rapidly expanding ecosystem shaped by public–private partnerships and commercial investment. This transformation is creating organizations that blend public-sector mandates (e.g., safety, national capability, accountability) with private-sector innovation, speed, and risk-taking, raising HR questions about how people systems function when goals, incentives, and constraints are hybrid rather than purely market- or state-driven (Mazzucato & Robinson, 2018; Robinson & Mazzucato, 2019; Snell & Morris, 2021). As the SE grows, workforce growth is expected across commercial, civil, defense, manufacturing, and digital service applications, intensifying demand for specialized labor and cross-boundary coordination (World Economic Forum & McKinsey & Company, 2024). These dynamics place the SE squarely within the HR Division’s strategic priorities: global talent management, emerging work contexts, and cross-sector collaboration. The SE depends on highly skilled engineers, analysts, system designers, and mission operations teams whose roles require substantial training and sustained performance under uncertainty, time pressure, and high consequence (Barley et al., 2017). In such settings, HR practices can materially shape innovation and operational outcomes, as performance shortfalls, turnover, or skill gaps can cascade into mission delay, safety risk, and major cost escalation (Bos-Nehles & Veenendaal, 2019; Kellner et al., 2023). This makes the SE a strong empirical setting for advancing theory on strategic workforce planning, capability development, retention, and high-consequence performance management. The SE also amplifies international and cross-sector HR challenges. Work is distributed across jurisdictions, institutional logics, and security/regulatory regimes, creating persistent questions about staffing and mobility, boundary-spanning collaboration, knowledge transfer, and governance of people practices across multi-actor partnerships and supply networks (Snell et al., 2023). This PDW aims to develop research designs on HR topics such as talent pipelines, learning systems, cross-boundary coordination, and HR architectures for reliability-demanding work.

RELEVANCE TO THE MED DIVISION

Near future challenges like space tourism, Mars habitat, orbital logistics, and asteroid mining provide a context for students to engage in creativity, systems thinking and long-term strategy. These scenarios activate competencies including uncertainty navigation, interdisciplinary thinking, and ethical reasoning—capabilities emphasized in contemporary management education (Fellenz et al., 2022). The Space Economy (SE) sits at the intersection of disciplines: advanced STEM (engineering, robotics, material science), business strategy, international policy, ethics (planetary protection, resource ownership), environmental sustainability (orbital debris, carbon impact), digital transformation (satellites, communication). This makes the SE an ideal context for cultivating cross-disciplinary thinking and anticipatory problem-solving. Such learning outcomes are emphasized in the discussion on the future of management (Fellenz et al., 2022). In parallel, recent work on futures literacy and strategic foresight argues that management education must help learners engage with uncertain, long-term societal trajectories, not just short-term business problems (Spanjol et al., 2023). The OECD (2018) “Future of Education and Skills 2030” framework similarly stresses the development of competencies such as agency, systems thinking, and responsibility for shared futures. Given its inherently multidisciplinary nature, the SE offers a motivating domain through which students can develop these competencies. Moreover, experiential designs that merge science fiction with entrepreneurship education have demonstrated their potential to foster bold futures thinking and opportunity recognition (Brändle & Kuckertz, 2024). Using the SE as an anchoring theme, educators can explore combinations of pedagogical approaches such as simulations, role plays, design sprints, and AI-enabled ideation labs to nurture future-ready leaders. This PDW invites educators and management education scholars interested in innovative integrative pedagogies, to join us in examining how the SE context can enrich teaching design, spark new research directions, and foster collaborative opportunities within the community.

RELEVANCE TO THE MC DIVISION

The interplay between government and industry space activities profoundly shapes the research and consulting landscape for members of the Academy of Management's Management Consulting Division. Dominance in the management consulting industry on one form over the other leads to incomplete and superficial understandings about the possibility of future industry activities. Understanding the differences between variance and process research is vital in organizational studies and management research. Variance research, which explains relationships between independent and dependent variables, is indispensable for identifying structural patterns and resource dependencies in government-industry collaborations, such as public-private partnerships in space infrastructure. Variance research focuses on explaining what causes what, identifying relationships between variables to predict outcomes. Conversely, process research, which narrates sequences of events, is critical to understanding dynamic phenomena like technology diffusion or regulatory adaptation over time. Process research delves into the “how” and “why” of phenomena, mapping event sequences to uncover patterns of development and change over time. These complementary approaches, as highlighted in Van de Ven's work, are essential to fully grasp the nonlinear and complex emergence of the space sector, where initial conditions (e.g., policy shocks or strategic alignments) and path dependencies play outsized roles. For management consultants, this means balancing predictive models with narrative insight, enabling nuanced strategies that account for both statistical generalities and idiosyncratic trajectories in this rapidly evolving field. By exploring these complementary approaches, we will discuss their strengths, limitations, and how integrating them can offer a more holistic understanding of complex organizational and social phenomena. This session is designed to equip you with the conceptual tools to navigate these methodologies and apply them effectively in your research and practice.

RELEVANCE TO THE PNP DIVISION

The rapidly expanding Space Economy (SE), driven by public-private collaborations, offers a prime context for understanding how NASA and the European Space Agency engage with private partners like SpaceX and Boeing. This dynamic informs public administrators seeking to enhance public value, technology-driven governance, and innovation. For instance, NASA's Shuttle design exemplifies knowledge governance in public-private partnerships (Roy, 2025), while emerging innovations influence administrative outcomes and decision-making (Compton et al., 2023). This PDW explores how space technologies could transform public and nonprofit organizations globally, underscoring the need to examine governance, knowledge-sharing, and strategic partnerships. For PNP members, it offers a unique forum to examine the space economy's impact on public and nonprofit sectors. Under "open government," public processes are increasingly digital and transparent, turning stakeholders—including citizens—into active co-producers. Space technologies like SpaceX's Starlink enable unprecedented connectivity and stakeholder engagement. Meanwhile, governments and nonprofits remain pivotal in advancing exploration, shaping policy (e.g., space security), and ensuring sustainable, ethical space governance. This PDW addresses critical management and policy challenges, examining the SE's ecosystem, sustainability, and social and ethical ramifications. In alignment with PNP's mission, it clarifies public institutions' and nonprofits' roles in a technology-driven, globally influential SE. The PDW highlights collaborative opportunities for PNP scholars, sparking dialogue that advances scholarship and practice in this rapidly evolving field. It fosters dialogue and collaborative research, enabling PNP members to adopt new frameworks for addressing space-related challenges. This PDW underscores the potential of space technologies in advancing public administration.

RELEVANCE TO THE SAP DIVISION

The rapid evolution of the space economy (World Economic Forum & McKinsey & Company, 2024) provides a rich context for studying strategy as practice in the interplay of public and private actors. This transformative setting allows us to explore how strategic management is enacted through everyday practices, tools, and routines in an industry shaped by uncertainty, innovation, and collaboration. Our PDW focuses on the day-to-day activities of strategy practitioners in space organizations, examining what members do to enact strategy (Whittington, 2006). For instance, observing decision-makers at NASA or SpaceX can uncover the practices and routines influencing strategic outcomes in high-stakes environments. Antoni et al.,’s (2024) examination of ESA’s open innovation highlights how blending traditional stakeholder engagement with adaptive practices keeps strategy development dynamic and collaborative. We also investigate how specific practices foster competitive advantage in the space sector, answering calls to clarify why practices matter strategically. Analyzing resource allocation in satellite manufacturing can reveal how these activities shape market positioning and strategic differentiation. The PDW aligns with the shift from micro to macro phenomena in SAP research, as it probes how micro-level practices aggregate into broader strategic and societal outcomes—particularly evident in grand challenges like space debris management or sustainable exploration. To advance research, we propose novel methodological approaches, including ethnographic studies of Blue Origin, SpaceX, and Virgin Galactic, alongside analyses of strategy documents and communication tools. These methods capture the subtleties of strategy work in action and open pathways for integrating SAP with other theoretical frameworks, such as institutional theory or dynamic capabilities (Vaara & Whittington, 2012). Beyond revealing what strategists do, our workshop examines the broader implications of these practices for sustainable space governance and stakeholder alignment.

RELEVANCE TO THE CM DIVISION

The SE is increasingly intertwined with collective security, making it a timely and theoretically rich setting for the CM Division's core interests in conflict, negotiation, and cooperation. As strategic competition extends into orbit, space becomes a domain where actors must pursue national and commercial objectives while managing escalation risks in an environment of high interdependence, limited transparency, and uncertain attribution. This raises central CM questions about how parties balance assertiveness and cooperativeness to secure interests without triggering destabilizing spirals; an ideal setting for extending bargaining and escalation theories, including dual-concern logics. The SE also reshapes the informational and operational foundations of conflict management. Space-enabled capabilities now underpin early warning, crisis monitoring, and verification functions essential to peacekeeping and arms-control regimes. At the same time, the rapid commercial diffusion of dual-use technologies introduces new vulnerabilities and pathways for rivalry, including geopolitical competition, cyber risks, contested norms, and regulatory ambiguity. These dynamics complicate attribution, heighten signaling ambiguity, and enable grey-zone tactics that challenge established mechanisms for deterrence and de-escalation. Equally important, the SE provides a live setting for studying how governance and institutional arrangements enable or constrain de-escalation. Frameworks such as the Outer Space Treaty establish baseline principles of responsibility and due regard, while new standards, norms, and industry practices are emerging to manage interference, collision avoidance, and responsible behavior. For CM scholars, this environment offers opportunities to study how norms are negotiated, how compliance is maintained, and how dispute-resolution mechanisms function when actors span states, militaries, agencies, and private firms with asymmetric capabilities. The PDW aims to develop research designs on CM topics such as: (1) escalation management, deterrence, and crisis bargaining under uncertainty and limited attribution; (2) negotiation and cooperation in multi-actor public-private security ecosystems; and (3) transparency, monitoring, and verification as mechanisms for de-escalation and institutional resilience across emerging multidomain conflicts.

RELEVANCE TO THE RM DIVISION

The RM division plays a pivotal role in advancing and sharing techniques for gathering, assessing, and interpreting data in management scholarship. The Space Economy (SE) is a rapidly evolving frontier that is both empirically consequential and methodologically distinctive (Paravano et al., 2024). Because SE opportunities, technical architectures, and interdependencies unfold over long time horizons and across multiple actors, studying them often requires approaches that can capture long-duration processes, multi-actor coordination, and cross-regime variation such as longitudinal process studies (Langley, 1999; McMullen & Dimov, 2013), comparative institutional analysis (Bruton et al., 2010), and ecosystem mapping approaches (Adner, 2017; Jacobides et al., 2018). Computational and network-based methods can further help trace the evolution of technological and organizational interdependence at scale, complementing qualitative designs that surface sensemaking, stakeholder positioning, and coordination dynamics. At the same time, research access is sometimes constrained by security restrictions and defence-related confidentiality, limiting the ability to study firms engaged in sensitive activities, while many ventures remain in early developmental stages; making snapshot designs insufficient to capture unfolding trajectories. Yet the SE also offers increasingly rich secondary data sources (including mission recordings, regulatory filings, procurement documents, and policy statements) which can complement primary data and enable scholars to reconstruct technological, organizational, and institutional developments over time. These features create a fertile environment for methodological innovation in RM, while also sharpening questions about research design quality, inference under opacity, and multi-level measurement in capital-intensive frontier settings (Crane et al., 2022; Lei et al., 2023). This PDW provides a platform for RM scholars to exchange and advance such method adaptations, catalyzing research teams and projects that refine tools for studying complex ecosystems and generating high-quality, publishable insights. By engaging with this domain, RM can expand its influence by shaping how management research studies and credibly evidences phenomena in the rapidly expanding SE.

RELEVANCE TO THE SIM DIVISION

The SE is a timely empirical setting for the SIM Division because it brings questions of responsibility, equity, and accountability to the fore as commercialization accelerates under fragmented governance. A core SIM question is how SE growth can advance society over the long term; using resources responsibly and limiting harms without compromising future generations (Di Tullio & Rea, 2024). Given the heterogeneous sustainability implications of space activity, it is useful to distinguish the social and environmental consequences produced by space operations from the contributions space-enabled capabilities can make to sustainable development on Earth (Verspieren, 2020). On the contribution side, the UN Office for Outer Space Affairs highlights that space applications can “turbocharge the achievement of the Sustainable Development Goals,” including disaster monitoring and response (SDG 1) and satellite-enabled remote learning (SDG 4) (Raswant et al., 2025). Satellite data also enable monitoring of deforestation and crop growth, including in less developed regions, raising SIM questions about impact measurement, stakeholder inclusion, and accountability for public value creation (Paravano et al., 2024). Reflecting the increasing role of multinational enterprises in commercialization, scholars have proposed an 18th SDG on “Sustainable Space” (Raswant et al., 2025). On the governance side, the SE sharpens SIM debates on ethics, justice, CSR, and corporate political activity. Space debris creates pollution and safety risks and illustrates governance gaps (OECD, 2023; Valente et al., 2025). Ethical guidelines are argued as necessary to prevent inequality, environmental harm, and monopolistic behavior as private actors expand. As privatization deepens, SIM scholars can examine how firms balance profit with public value and intergenerational equity (Peeters & Ehrenfreund, 2025; Elvis et al., 2022). Corporate interventions with geopolitical consequences (e.g., Starlink in Ukraine) raise questions of consent, legitimacy, and accountability (Dave, Simha & Topuzova, 2024). The SE’s global supply chains also invite SIM research on human rights in production networks (Reinecke et al., 2018), while commercial human spaceflight raises issues of risk, safety, consent, and responsibility beyond technical design (Langston, 2016, 2017).

RELEVANCE TO THE NEUB DIVISION

The rapidly growing SE, including long-duration missions, commercial space stations, and increasingly routine operations in extreme environments, offers a distinctive empirical setting for NEUB scholarship on the neurobiological and physiological foundations of work behavior. Unlike most organizational contexts, space operations systematically combine microgravity, confinement, isolation, circadian disruption, and high-consequence decision-making, creating a frontier setting where biological mechanisms are not background conditions but central determinants of individual and team performance. Emerging evidence suggests that microgravity can be associated with changes in neurostructural connectivity and cognitive functioning, while prolonged confinement and isolation shape stress physiology and affect coordination dynamics, including patterns of team physiological synchrony. For NEUB scholars, the SE therefore functions as an “extreme case” that can sharpen theory by revealing mechanisms and boundary conditions that are harder to observe in typical workplaces. It enables research that links biological states to organizational phenomena central to NEUB and adjacent divisions (e.g., leadership under strain, fatigue and vigilance, team cognition and coordination, and adaptation in high-reliability settings). Methodologically, the SE also foregrounds the growing role of neuro- and bio-sensing technologies for organizational research. The use of tools such as EEG, fNIRS, and continuous biometric monitoring in space and analog environments provides opportunities to connect real-time physiological dynamics with training, task design, and operational decision-making while also raising questions about measurement validity, inference, and generalizability. Finally, the SE elevates ethical issues that are increasingly salient for NEUB: the permissible limits of physiological monitoring, data governance and consent in safety-critical roles, and the implications of cognitive enhancement in extreme work contexts (Hardy et al., 2025; Wang et al., 2025). The PDW invites NEUB members to translate these opportunities into research designs, integrating biological mechanisms with multi-level organizational theory and feasible empirical strategies.

RELEVANCE TO THE ODC DIVISION

The SE offers an unusually strong empirical setting for ODC because it concentrates large-scale transformation under extreme constraints: high reliability and safety demands, long time horizons, capital intensity, and tight interdependence across public agencies, primes, startups, and research universities. These conditions make change highly consequential and difficult to execute, providing a “high-resolution” context to examine how organizations initiate, legitimize, implement, and sustain change when technologies, governance arrangements, and stakeholder values shift rapidly. This is a setting in which ODC theory and intervention research can surface mechanisms and boundary conditions that remain muted in more routine change contexts. The SE foregrounds classic change questions (e.g., sensemaking, resistance, culture shift, and intervention design) in settings where multiple logics collide and where failure has outsized costs. Major transitions (e.g., moving from government-centric programs to hybrid public–private models) often trigger intensive sensemaking/sensegiving and identity work about “what mission success means” and “who we are” (Maitlis & Christianson, 2014). Change in the SE is rarely contained within one organization: it propagates through contracts, standards, platform architectures, and interdependent supply networks, creating a fertile context for studying multi-actor change, governance hybridity, and cross-boundary coordination. These dynamics also sharpen ODC interest in resistance, power, and legitimacy; specifically, how competing coalitions define “responsible change,” who benefits from “new space” transformations, who bears risk, and how contested change is negotiated inside and across organizations. The PDW aims to translate these frontier dynamics into actionable, practice-relevant research designs on ODC topics such as (1) designing and evaluating change interventions in hybrid public–private ecosystems; (2) managing speed–safety tensions while preserving psychological safety and learning; (3) understanding resistance and coalition dynamics across legacy and entrepreneurial actors; and (4) developing practical change playbooks for organizations navigating uncertainty, interdependence, and shifting governance.

RELEVANCE TO THE CAR DIVISION

The SE is a distinctive setting for the CAR Division because it concentrates career phenomena that are central to contemporary careers scholarship: rapid occupational emergence, boundary-spanning work, institutional constraint, and high-stakes project environments. As the sector scales, organizations face a well-documented tension between demand for scarce, specialized expertise and the need for integrative profiles; often described as T-shaped or V-shaped capabilities that combine deep technical knowledge with cross-functional coordination, systems thinking, and strategic judgment (Goldman et al., 2025; Westover, 2024). This creates a rich empirical context for examining how workers build employability, craft skill portfolios, and navigate career transitions when roles evolve quickly and competency requirements are not yet standardized. The SE also sharpens how institutions shape careers. Compared with many industries, space-related work is strongly conditioned by public procurement, safety and certification regimes, and (especially in dual-use domains) security requirements that structure access to projects, knowledge, and mobility (Jenkins, 2024). Funding concentration and ecosystem dominance can further shape opportunity structures for individuals and smaller firms (OECD, 2023), raising CAR questions about career inequality, cumulative advantage, and the formation of “career ladders” within emerging ecosystems. At the same time, careers in the SE are often built across porous organizational boundaries (e.g., agencies, primes, startups, suppliers, universities), making it an ideal setting to study boundaryless careers in practice; alongside the countervailing forces that re-impose boundaries through regulation, sovereignty concerns, and restricted knowledge flows. For CAR scholars, the SE therefore functions as a context to develop and test theory on topics such as: (1) career adaptability and resilience under long-horizon uncertainty and career shocks; (2) mobility and identity across hybrid public–private ecosystems; and (3) how institutional architectures create or constrain opportunity. The PDW offers a platform to translate these mechanisms into research designs with clear constructs, comparative settings, and feasible data strategies.

APPENDIX II: PARTICIPANTS

Organizer / PDW Chair: Mehdi Montakhabi

Distinguished Keynote Speakers: Clay Mowry (CEO, American Institute of Aeronautics and Astronautics) & Christopher Tucci (President-Elect of the Academy of Management)

Academic Panelists: Kathleen Eisenhardt, Ron Adner, & Matthew Weinzierl

Industry Panelists: Dr. Lucie Low (Chief Science Officer, Axiom Space), Brad Handerson (Chief Commercial Officer, Starlab Space), Ryan Reel (Vice President, Outpost Space), Sanjeev Gordhan (General Partner, Type One Ventures), and Luis Zea (Chief Scientist, Starlab Space). Additional representatives are to be confirmed from other space companies (e.g., Vast Space), alongside one or two representatives from space agencies (e.g., NASA, ESA).

Facilitators: Esteve Almirall Mezquita, Erkko Autio, Ken Davidian, Sebastian Herbert Fuchs, Oksana Gerwe, Michael John Gill, Devi R. Gnyawali, Marc Gruber, Tony Guidotti, Fredrik Hacklin, Felix Honecker, Nien-hê Hsieh, Marin Jovanovic, Donald Kuratko, Benn Lawson, Petteri Leppänen, Yong Li, David Raj Mahto, Gideon Markman, Lorenzo Massa, Gemma Milne, Xaver Neumeyer, Markus Perkman, Magdalena Marczevska, Jeffrey Martin, Antonio Messeni Petruzzelli, Kevin Rockmann, Jens Roehrich, Tamara Roth, Yue Song, Brian Squire, Mary Sully de Luque, Paolo Trucco, Marc Ventresca, Tim Vorley, Yueling Zhou

Participant¹ (or other roles): Enrique Acebo, Francisca Alvarez Figueroa, Abhishek Behl, Janet Lee Elsie Bercovitz, Elettra D'Amico, Zouheir El Kawas, Carlo Giglio, Ameek Kaur, Stefan Korber, Yuan Li, Marta Lindvert, William Luse, Catherine McDonald, Juergen Meissner, Marco Minciullo, Mayukh Mukhopadhyay, Terry Pagan, Andreas Raspotnik, Elie Saad, Johannes Schmied-Wirén, Piotr

¹ Participants are those whose contributions were incorporated into the proposal (especially within the “Relevance to Divisions” sections) or, if not used directly, helped shape and inform the final version of the proposal.

Staszkiewicz, Iselin Kristine Mauseth Steira, Felipe Symmes, Beverly Tyler, Andrea Wang, Jinmin Wang, Valentina Zancan, Maurizio Zollo